

CSE 203 Computer Ethics and Cyber Law – Tutorial 3 Mark 20

Q1. Explain a few common ethical issues regarding the relationship between IT professionals and Suppliers. Discuss a few initiatives that will support the ethical practices of IT users. **[5 marks]**

Q2. “Rifat and his friends, aged between 13 and 17, were very fond of action-oriented, role-playing computer games. After some time, severe changes were noticed in their behavior. They wanted to play the games for longer durations. They became very aggressive, started using offensive language, and often got into conflicts with their peers on minor issues. A psychiatrist suggested that the violence that the children observed in the computer games had a negative effect on them.”

Do you think it is ethically correct for a programmer or a company to produce such games? Answer taking software engineering code of ethics into consideration. **[5 marks]**

Q3. Explain the following terms with respect to computer ethics:

(i) Globalization (ii) Digital Divide (iii) Net Neutrality. **[6 marks]**

Q4. Discuss the dilemma between moral responsibility and personal/organizational risks of whistle-blowing. **[4 marks]**

Solutions :

Q1. Ethical issues between IT professionals and suppliers & initiatives for ethical IT use

Ethical Issues:

1. **Bribery and Gifts:** Suppliers may offer expensive gifts or benefits to influence decisions. IT professionals must avoid accepting anything that affects fairness.
2. **Conflict of Interest:** Choosing a supplier for personal benefit instead of organizational benefit is unethical.
3. **Lack of Transparency:** Hidden agreements or secret deals with suppliers violate professional integrity.
4. **Unreasonable Demands:** IT professionals should not misuse their authority to pressure suppliers.

Initiatives to Support Ethical IT Practices:

1. **IT Usage Policies:** Clear rules defining acceptable and unacceptable use of IT resources.
 2. **Software Licensing Guidelines:** Prevent software piracy and illegal copying.
 3. **Security Measures:** Firewalls, access control, and data protection systems.
 4. **Awareness and Training:** Educating users about ethical and responsible IT behavior.
-

Q2. Is producing violent games ethically correct? (Software Engineering Code of Ethics)

Producing such games can be ethically questionable if they negatively affect users, especially children.

According to the **Software Engineering Code of Ethics:**

- **Public Interest Principle:** Software engineers must act in the public interest. If a game causes aggression or harmful behavior, it may violate this principle.
- **Quality of Life Clause:** Engineers should not create software that harms users' well-being.
- **Professional Responsibility:** Developers should consider social and psychological impacts before releasing products.

However, companies can reduce ethical concerns by using **age ratings, parental controls, and warnings.**

Therefore, producing such games is only ethically acceptable if proper safeguards are implemented to protect users.

Q3. Terms in computer ethics

(i) Globalization:

The worldwide integration of businesses, communication, and services through information technology, allowing people and organizations to operate across national boundaries.

(ii) Digital Divide:

The gap between people who have access to modern technology (internet, computers) and those who do not, leading to inequality in opportunities.

(iii) Net Neutrality:

The principle that all internet data should be treated equally by service providers without favoring or blocking particular websites or services.

Q4. Dilemma of whistle-blowing

Whistle-blowing means reporting illegal or unethical activities inside an organization.

Moral Responsibility:

- Protecting public safety and preventing harm.
- Following professional ethics and honesty.

Personal and Organizational Risks:

- Losing job, harassment, financial problems.
- Damage to company reputation and internal trust.

Dilemma:

The individual must choose between doing the morally right thing and facing serious personal or career consequences.